AUDIO

The front-firing stereo speaker arrangement paired with the custom 2.8-inch woofer delivers sound that consistently over-performs for the device's size and price. Spatial audio support gives music and podcast content genuine room-filling quality and spoken-word audio in particular sounds full and warm. For casual listening while cooking, working or moving around a room, the Echo Show 11 holds up well.

At higher volume levels, the bass can occasionally overpower vocals. This becomes noticeable during dialogue-heavy content such as news programmes, podcasts and video calls. At moderate volumes, the balance is much better and for everyday use most listeners will not encounter the problem.



OMNISENSE

Omnisense is the Echo Show 11's most distinctive feature and the most significant addition to the Echo Show platform in recent memory. The sensor platform fuses ultrasound and Wi-Fi radar to detect presence and fine motion, pairs this with a built-in thermistor for room temperature sensing and uses these inputs to trigger automated Alexa routines without any manual interaction.

This means the device can detect whether someone is in a room, whether they are actively moving or sitting still and whether the temperature has crossed a set threshold, then act accordingly. Presence-based routines that adjust lighting, play sleep sounds after a certain hour, or activate smart fans based on room temperature work reliably once configured. The ambient intelligence concept here is greatly useful and meaningfully more capable than what competing smart displays offer.

The configuration process, however, is more complex than it needs to be. Setting up Omnisense routines through the app requires navigating several layers of settings and that can be frustrating for users new to smart homes. The tech rewards patience, but first-time users should expect a setup period before it delivers. The temperature-based routines in particular are only as useful as the compatible smart home devices already in place.

PRIVACY

Physical controls for the microphone and camera are present and voice recording management is accessible through the Alexa Privacy Hub. The controls are adequate and reasonably easy to access.

What the Echo Show 11 lacks is a physical privacy shutter for its 13 MP camera. On a device with always-on ambient sensing capabilities and a front-facing camera designed for home monitoring and video calls, the absence of a physical cover is a meaningful omission. Software controls and voice commands can disable the camera, but a physical shutter provides a level of reassurance that software cannot replicate. For privacy-conscious buyers, this is a factor worth weighing carefully before purchase.

It is also worth noting that the next generation of Alexa, powered by generative AI, has not yet launched in India. Amazon has confirmed the Echo Show 11 is designed to support it when it does arrive, which means the platform's ceiling is higher than what the current software delivers. Whether that future upgrade arrives quickly enough to matter is an open question.

VERDICT

The Echo Show 11 is the most complete smart display Amazon has made. The Full HD panel is a great upgrade over its predecessor, the audio system over-delivers for its size and price and Omnisense's ambient intelligence opens up a tier of smart home automation that competing devices in this category cannot match. At Rs 26,999, the hardware makes a strong case.

But the limitations are also very real. No physical camera shutter on a device with this level of sensing capability is a gap. YouTube via the Silk browser is a step down from native app access. The swivel base is gone and Omnisense's setup complexity undersells what the technology can actually do and Alexa's contextual understanding remains inconsistent in places.

– Siddharth Chauhan

SPECIFICATIONS

Display: 10.95-inch Full HD touchscreen, 1920 x 1200 px | Processor: AZ3 Pro with AI Accelerator | Storage: 8GB eMMC | Camera: 13MP | Audio: 1x 2.8-inch woofer, 2x full-range drivers, spatial audio | Connectivity: WiFi 6E, Bluetooth 5.3 | Sensors: Omnisense platform: ultrasound, Wi-Fi radar, accelerometer, ambient light, ambient temperature | OS: Vega

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